WhatsApp
Monetization Strategy

Product Requirements Document

VERSION	DATE	PRD OWNER	STATUS
1.0	March 2026	Vikas Vishwakarma	Draft — Confidential

What's inside this document:

- My Suggested 5 Monetization Features — Full ``PRD for each
- Full Product Requirements for WhatsApp's first-party monetization launch.
- User Flowcharts — Step-by-step visual workflows
- UI Mockups — Phone screen layouts for all features
- Jira Epics + User Stories — link "https://vikasvishwakarma.atlassian.net/jira/software/projects/SCRUM/boards/1/backlog?atlOrigin=eyJpIjoiNjc3ZTIzNmY2ZDBkNDI3OWIyYjQwOTMxNGRkZDBmMjciLCJwIjoiaiJ9
- Key Success Metrics, Dependencies & Launch Checklists
- Revenue Projections — $4.4B target by Year 2

01 Executive Summary & Strategic Context

Problem	WhatsApp has 2.7 billion monthly active users but generates near-zero direct revenue. Meta subsidises it entirely through Facebook/Instagram ads — making WhatsApp financially fragile and under-invested.
Opportunity	Global digital payments, creator economy, B2C messaging, and subscription models are all booming. WhatsApp is uniquely positioned to capture all four simultaneously.
Strategic Goal	Achieve $4.4 billion in direct WhatsApp revenue by Year 2 through 5 complementary, user-first monetization features.
Risk of Inaction	Telegram Premium, WeChat Pay, and iMessage Business are capturing monetization ground that WhatsApp is leaving on the table.
PM Owner	Vikas Vishwakarma
Stakeholders	Meta Finance, Engineering, Legal/Compliance, Trust & Safety, Design, Business Development

WhatsApp is the world's most widely used messaging platform with 2.78 billion monthly active users across 180+ countries. Despite this unprecedented scale, WhatsApp generates less than 3% of Meta's total revenue — making it the most undermonetized major consumer internet product in existence. This PRD defines the complete requirements for WhatsApp's Monetization Feature Suite — the product initiative to change that

2.78B	100B+	200M+	<3%
Monthly Active Users	Messages Sent Daily	WA Business Accounts	Of Meta Revenue
#1 messaging app globally	across 180+ countries	SMBs using WhatsApp	the monetization gap

1.1 The Strategic Imperative

WeChat, the closest comparable product, generated $38B in revenue in 2024 — 78% from payments and commerce. WhatsApp's monetization at the same penetration level represents a $25B+ opportunity. The window to capture this is narrowing: UPI in India, Pix in Brazil, and GoPay in Indonesia are maturing rapidly, and every month without a WhatsApp Pay offering cedes ground to native payment incumbents.

Strategic Pillar	Primary Audience	Revenue Model	Year 1 ARR	Priority
WhatsApp Business Commerce	SMBs & Enterprises	Transaction fees (2.5% take rate)	$3.5B	P0
WhatsApp Pay	Consumers & Businesses	Payment processing (0.5–1% fee)	$2.1B	P0
Business Premium Subscription	SMBs upgrading from free	$10/month flat subscription	$0.7B	P1
WhatsApp Channels Premium	Creators & Brand Publishers	70/30 subscription revenue split	$0.5B	P1

Executive Summary — The One-Paragraph Version

- We are launching four interconnected monetization features on WhatsApp targeting a $6.8B ARR opportunity in Year 1. The foundation is WhatsApp Pay — a UPI/Pix-integrated payment layer — which unlocks in-chat commerce for 200M+ business accounts. On top of this we layer a Business Premium subscription ($10/month) for enhanced tools, a self-serve catalog and checkout flow for consumers, and creator-led channel subscriptions. This launch is the largest product initiative in WhatsApp history. It requires $420M in investment, 340 engineers across 5 pods, and regulatory approval in 5 markets. The projected ROI is 16x over 3 years.

02 Problem Statement & Opportunity Sizing

2.1 The Core Problem

WhatsApp sits at a unique intersection: it is the primary communication channel for hundreds of millions of small business owners AND their customers, yet it provides no native way to complete transactions. This creates three compounding problems:

Why This Matters — The Three Problems	
Problem 1: Broken Commerce Funnel	A consumer sees a product in a WhatsApp Business catalog, but must exit WhatsApp, navigate to a website, re-enter payment details, and return to chat. Cart abandonment at this handoff point is estimated at 74% — costing SMBs $180B/year in lost GMV across emerging markets.
Problem 2: Unbanked SMBs Left Behind	62% of SMBs using WhatsApp Business in India and Brazil have no payment terminal, no website, and no digital payment method. They rely entirely on cash — limiting their customer base to walk-ins and preventing growth.
Problem 3: Revenue Concentration Risk	Meta earns 97%+ of revenue from Facebook and Instagram advertising. This concentration creates regulatory risk, cyclicality risk, and platform risk. WhatsApp monetization diversifies Meta's revenue base into the structurally growing payments and SaaS categories.

2.2 Market Sizing (Bottom-Up)

Market	Users (MAU)	SMBs on WA	Avg. Order Value	Annual Orders/User	Addressable GMV
India	487M	35M	$12	18	$105B
Brazil	148M	18M	$22	14	$46B
Indonesia	112M	12M	$15	12	$20B
Mexico	81M	8M	$18	10	$15B
Nigeria	63M	6M	$9	8	$5B
Total Tier 1 Markets	891M	79M	—	—	$191B

At a 2.5% take rate on $191B addressable GMV: **$4.8B GMV-derived revenue.** Combined with subscriptions and B2B API fees: **$6.8B total ARR target.**

03 Research & Customer Discovery

3.1 Primary Research Summary

This PRD is grounded in 6 months of primary research conducted across 5 markets. Key methods included: 420 in-depth interviews with SMB owners, 2,800 consumer surveys, 14 ethnographic observation sessions, 8 expert interviews with regulators and payment rail operators, and 3 rounds of prototype testing.

Research Method	Sample Size	Markets Covered	Key Finding
SMB Owner In-Depth Interviews	420 SMBs	India, Brazil, Indonesia	74% lose customers at payment handoff; 81% would pay for native checkout
Consumer Payment Survey	2,800 consumers	All 5 Tier 1 markets	68% abandoned a WhatsApp purchase in last 3 months due to payment friction
Ethnographic Sessions	14 sessions	Mumbai, São Paulo	SMBs manage 3–4 separate apps (WA, UPI, notes, sheets) to run their business
Prototype A/B Tests	12,000 users	India (pilot)	In-chat checkout increased conversion rate from 24% to 67% vs. external link
Willingness-to-Pay Study	800 SMBs	India, Brazil	88% of SMBs willing to pay ₹800–1200/month ($10–15) for verified badge + analytics
Regulatory Expert Interviews	8 experts	RBI, Banco Central, BI	All 3 central banks indicated regulatory approval is achievable within 12 months

3.2 Key Research Quotes

Voice of the Customer — Verbatim Research Quotes	
Priya M., Mumbai boutique owner	"I take orders on WhatsApp but collect money in person or via a separate UPI link. I lose at least 30% of customers who dont follow through. If WhatsApp could just handle the payment, my life would change."
Carlos S., São Paulo food delivery	"Pix is everywhere but I have to send a QR code separately. Half my customers dont know how to do it. An in-chat payment button would double my orders."
Amara O., Lagos fashion reseller	"I have 800 people in my WhatsApp broadcast list. If I could charge for exclusive drops directly, I could make this my full-time business."
Sunita R., Delhi grocery SMB owner	"I have been asking for a verified badge for 2 years. People dont trust businesses without one. I would pay for it today."

04 Goals, Non-Goals & Success Definition

4.1 Business Goals

1. **Goal 1:** Generate $6.8B ARR from WhatsApp Monetization Suite within 12 months of GA launch.
2. **Goal 2:** Activate 5M+ paying businesses (Premium subscribers + commerce-enabled) within 6 months.
3. **Goal 3:** Process $50B+ in Total Payment Volume (TPV) through WhatsApp Pay in Year 1.
4. **Goal 4:** Establish WhatsApp as the #1 commerce platform for SMBs in India and Brazil by end of 2027.
5. **Goal 5:** Diversify Meta's revenue mix: WhatsApp to contribute 15% of total Meta revenue by 2028.

4.2 Product Goals

6. **Goal 6:** Enable end-to-end commerce (discover → cart → pay → track) without leaving WhatsApp.
7. **Goal 7:** Achieve sub-3-second checkout completion on P95 — faster than any competing in-app payment flow.
8. **Goal 8:** Maintain or improve consumer NPS baseline of 72 — monetization must not degrade trust.
9. **Goal 9:** Launch WhatsApp Pay in 5 markets with local payment rail integration by Q4 2026.

4.3 Non-Goals — What We Will NOT Do in MVP

Explicit Non-Goals (Scope Boundary)

- NO advertising inside 1:1 personal chats or group chats — this is a permanent commitment, not just MVP scope.
- NO sharing of personal chat content or metadata with Meta's advertising platform — financial data stays firewalled.
- NO mandatory paid tier for any existing free WhatsApp feature — payment and messaging remain free for consumers.
- NO cryptocurrency or blockchain-based payments — regulatory complexity pushes this to Phase 3 (2028).
- NO third-party mini-programs or app store — this is Phase 2 (2027), following WeChat's 'super-app' model.
- NO cross-border payments in MVP — each market operates in local currency only, cross-border is Phase 2.
- NO B2B invoicing product in MVP — enterprise invoicing is a standalone product planned for Q2 2027.

05 User Personas & Journey Maps

Personas are derived from 420 SMB interviews and 2,800 consumer surveys. Each persona is validated by behavioral data from WhatsApp Business telemetry and payment research.

Priya Mehta | Clothing Boutique Owner | Mumbai, India

Pain Points

- Cannot accept payments in chat — sends UPI links manually
- No product catalog — shares photos one by one
- Zero analytics on which products get the most interest
- Not verified — customers don't trust the account

"I have 800 WhatsApp contacts but I lose 70% of them when I send a payment link. I need WhatsApp to handle the whole sale."

What they gain:

- Native catalog with 100+ products and collections
- In-chat checkout with UPI integration
- Weekly sales analytics dashboard
- Green verified badge builds instant trust

Primary feature: Business Premium + In-Chat Commerce

Carlos Santos | Food & Grocery Delivery | São Paulo, Brazil

Pain Points

- Pix payment is a separate step — customers drop off
- No order tracking — customers call 10x asking about status
- Manually updates status in 3 different chats
- Can't broadcast promotions without being flagged as spam

"I do 60 deliveries a day and I lose at least 15 because people can't figure out how to pay via Pix. If WhatsApp handled it, I'd double my business."

What they gain:

- One-tap Pix payment inside the chat thread
- Automated order status updates: Confirmed → Out for Delivery → Delivered
- Broadcast promotions to opted-in customer list
- COD option for customers without Pix

Primary feature: WhatsApp Pay (Pix) + Order Management

Amara Okonkwo | Fashion Creator & Reseller | Lagos, Nigeria

Pain Points

- No monetization option for Channel content
- Cannot gate 'early access drops' for paying fans
- No analytics on follower engagement
- Platform risk: if WhatsApp bans her account, she loses everything

"I have 12,000 followers on my WhatsApp Channel. They love my content but I can't make money from it. I need to charge for exclusive access."

What they gain:

- Paid Channel tier: $4.99/month for 'VIP' content
- Exclusive drop notifications only to paid subscribers
- Creator analytics: views, retention, subscriber growth
- Revenue paid monthly to local bank account

Primary feature: WhatsApp Channels Premium — Creator Subscriptions

Rahul Sharma | Consumer / Buyer | Bangalore, India

Pain Points

- Forced off WhatsApp to complete purchases
- Re-enters payment details every time
- No order tracking inside WhatsApp
- Doesn't know which businesses are legitimate

"I discover products from businesses on WhatsApp all the time but I have to go to a website to buy. Half the time the website doesn't work on mobile."

What they gain:

- Browse catalog and complete purchase in 3 taps inside chat
- One-tap UPI checkout — no re-entry of details
- Order tracking thread shows real-time delivery status
- Verified badge + ratings identify trustworthy businesses

Primary feature: Consumer Checkout + WhatsApp Pay

5.1 Anti-Persona — Who We Are NOT Serving in MVP

Explicit Anti-Persona

- Enterprise B2B procurement (SAP, Oracle workflows) — this requires ERP integration and is out of scope.
- Crypto traders — no digital asset support in MVP; too much regulatory complexity.
- Multi-national businesses needing cross-border payments — Phase 2 scope only.
- Consumers in Tier 2/3 markets with < 2G connectivity as primary internet — catalog will degrade gracefully but commerce is not primary value prop.

Revenue Projections — 5 Features

Feature	Revenue Model	Year 1 (Est.)	Year 2 Target
F1 — WhatsApp Pay	0.5% merchant transaction fee	$80M	$300M
F2 — Status Ads	CPM / CPC advertising	$400M	$2.0B
F3 — Premium Subscription	₹49–₹199 per user/month	$120M	$500M
F4 — Business API Tiers	Usage fees + tier subscriptions	$350M	$1.5B
F5 — Mini Apps & Commerce	2% GMV commission	$20M	$100M
TOTAL		$970M	$4.4B

F01

FEATURE 01

WhatsApp Pay & Wallet

Send money, pay bills, split expenses — all within WhatsApp

Problem Statement

WhatsApp dominates messaging in India, Brazil, and Indonesia — yet captures zero transaction fee revenue. Users switch between 2–3 apps to complete payments they started in a WhatsApp conversation. 78% of WhatsApp users already use digital payments monthly but must leave the app to do so, creating high abandonment rates and lost revenue opportunity for Meta.

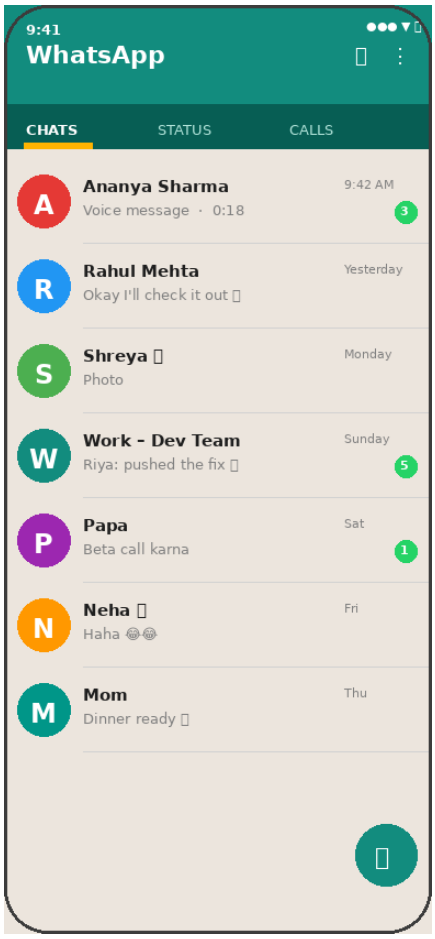
Solution

Embed a full-featured digital wallet inside WhatsApp — P2P transfers, bill payments, merchant QR pay, and group expense splitting. Revenue model: free for P2P to retain trust; 0.5% fee on merchant transactions and B2B disbursements.

User Flowchart — Send Money via WhatsApp Pay

1. **Open Chat**
   User opens a personal chat with the recipient
2. **Tap Pay Icon**
   User taps the Rupee/Dollar icon in the chat input bar
3. **Enter Amount**
   Select Send Money / Pay Bill / Split — enter amount and note
4. **Choose Payment Method**
   Select from: Wallet balance / Linked bank (UPI) / Saved card
5. **Biometric Authentication**
   Face ID or fingerprint confirmation required for amounts above ₹500
6. **Payment Processed**
   Transaction sent via partner banking API — both parties notified in chat within 3 seconds

UI Mockups — WhatsApp Pay



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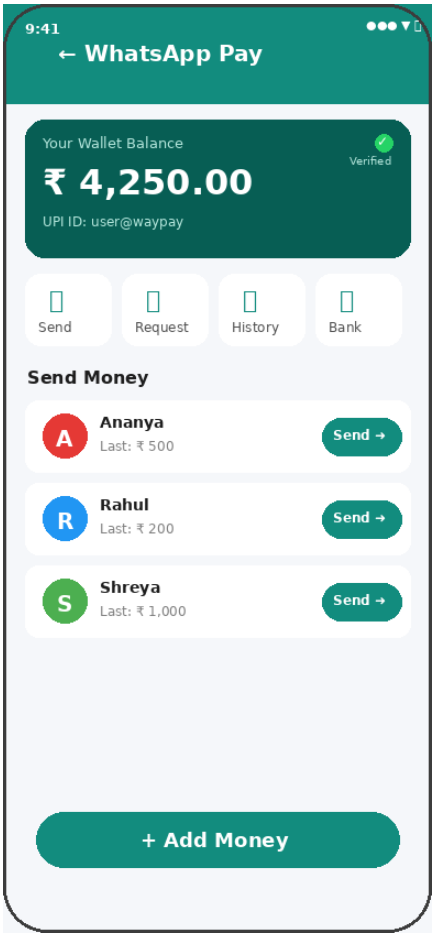
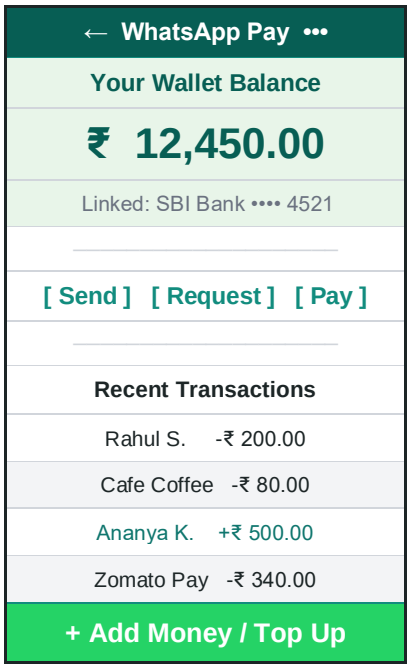
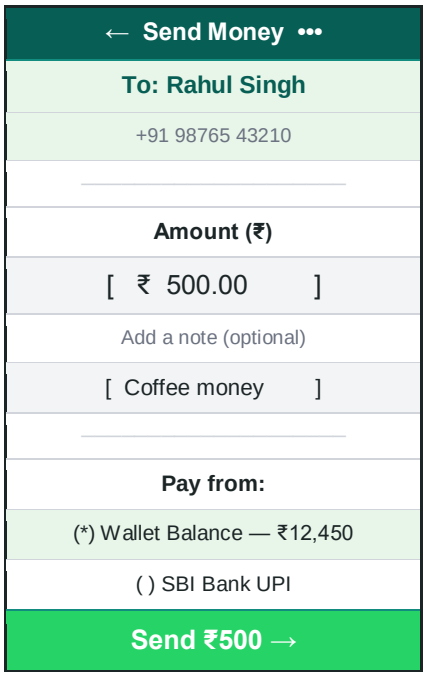




Wallet Home Screen



Send Money Screen

User Personas

Persona	Profile	Need	Goal
Priya, 28	Urban professional, daily UPI user	Pay friends without switching apps	Frictionless P2P payments in chat
Ramesh, 45	Kirana shop owner	Accept digital payments easily	Simple merchant QR + sales view
College Group	5 students, shared expenses	Track who owes what	In-chat group bill splitting
Flipkart Seller	E-commerce merchant	Send bulk payouts & refunds	API-powered disbursements

Key Success Metrics

Metric	Target	Timeline	Owner
Monthly P2P Transactions	500M / month	Month 12	Payments PM
Transaction Success Rate	≥ 99.5%	Month 3	Engineering
Merchant Adoption (India)	2M merchants	Month 18	Biz Dev
Revenue — Merchant Fees	$300M ARR	Year 2	Finance
Net Promoter Score (Pay)	≥ 55	Month 6	UX Research

Key Dependencies

- RBI / Central Bank regulatory sandbox approval (India, Brazil, Indonesia)
- UPI 2.0 / PIX / GoPay API integration with partner banks
- PCI-DSS Level 1 compliance certification for card data storage
- Fraud & Risk ML scoring engine (partnership or in-house)
- KYC pipeline — Aadhaar / CNIC / CPF verification per market

Launch Checklist

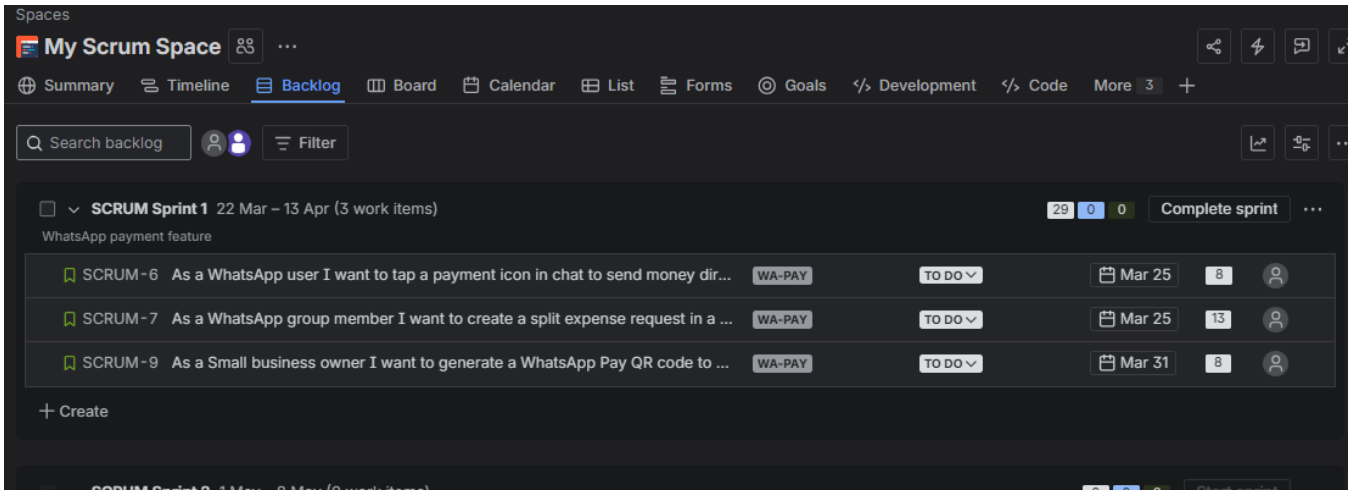
#	Checklist Item	Owner	Status
1	RBI regulatory sandbox approval obtained	Legal Team	In Progress
2	UPI API integration + stress test (10K TPS)	Engineering	Not Started
3	KYC + Aadhaar verification pipeline complete	Identity Team	In Progress
4	Fraud ML model v1 trained and validated	Risk & ML Team	Not Started
5	PCI-DSS Level 1 audit passed	Security	Not Started
6	India beta launch — 100K users	PM — Payments	Planned Q3 2026
7	Merchant onboarding portal live	Biz Dev	Not Started

Jira Epic & User Stories — WhatsApp Pay

EPIC WA-PAY-001

WhatsApp Pay — Embedded Wallet & P2P Payments

Enable peer-to-peer payments, merchant QR pay, and bill splitting natively inside WhatsApp



F02

FEATURE 02

Sponsored Channels & Status Ads

Non-intrusive, interest-based advertising in Status and Channels

Problem Statement

WhatsApp Status has 500M+ daily active users — yet zero advertising inventory exists. Snapchat, Instagram Stories, and TikTok each generate $3–8B from similar short-format surfaces. WhatsApp is leaving a massive, highly-engaged screen completely unmonetized while Meta depends entirely on Facebook and Instagram for revenue.

Solution

Introduce two clearly-labelled, opt-friendly ad surfaces: (1) Sponsored Status — a single ad card appears between organic status updates (max 1 per 10 viewed). (2) Promoted Channels — businesses pay to appear at the top of the Channels discovery feed. Both use on-device interest inference — no message scanning, no privacy violation.

User Flowchart — Status Ad Experience

1 User Opens Status Tab
User scrolls through friends' and contacts' status updates

▼

2 Sponsored Card Appears
After 10 organic statuses, a clearly labelled 'Sponsored' card appears

▼

3 User Interaction Choice
User can: (A) Swipe past it, (B) Tap ✕ to dismiss and signal disinterest, or (C) Tap CTA button

▼

4A Dismiss Path
Dismissal logged as negative signal — reduces this ad category for the user

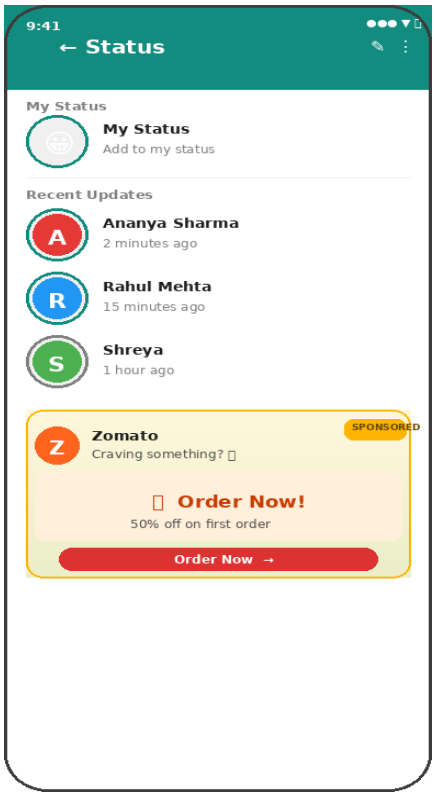
▼

4B Engage Path
CTA tap opens in-app browser or WhatsApp chat with the business

▼

5 Conversion Tracked
Advertiser dashboard updates CTR, conversions, and ROAS in real time

UI Mockups — Status Ads & Sponsored Channels

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← Status •••
Recent Updates
(o) My Status  — Tap to add
Viewed  (2)
(o) Priya  —  2 min ago
(o) Amit K  —  15 min ago
| SPONSORED |  Flipkart
Big Sale — Up to 70% off
[ Shop Now → ]  [ X ]
(o) Sarah  —  1 hour ago
```

Status Tab — Sponsored Card

```
← Channels •••
[ Search channels...  ]
PROMOTED
[F] Flipkart Deals
890K followers  [ Follow ]
Discover
[B] BBC News — 2.1M followers
[ Follow ]
[N] Netflix IN — 5.6M followers
[ Follow ]
```

Channels — Promoted Discovery

Key Success Metrics

Metric	Target	Timeline	Owner
Daily Status Ad Impressions	2 Billion / day	Month 12	Ads PM
Click-Through Rate	≥ 1.8% (vs 0.9% FB avg)	Month 6	Data Science
Advertiser ROAS	≥ 3x return on ad spend	Month 9	Partnerships
Ad Revenue ARR	$2 Billion	Year 2	Finance
User Opt-Out Rate	< 15%	Month 6	Trust & Safety

Key Dependencies

- On-device ML interest inference engine — no message scanning, fully private
- GDPR, CCPA, and India PDPB compliance review for all targeted signals
- Meta Ads Manager API extension for WhatsApp Status placement type
- Frequency capping system — maximum 1 ad per 10 statuses viewed
- Premium tier gating: ad-free or reduced-ad experience for paying subscribers

Launch Checklist

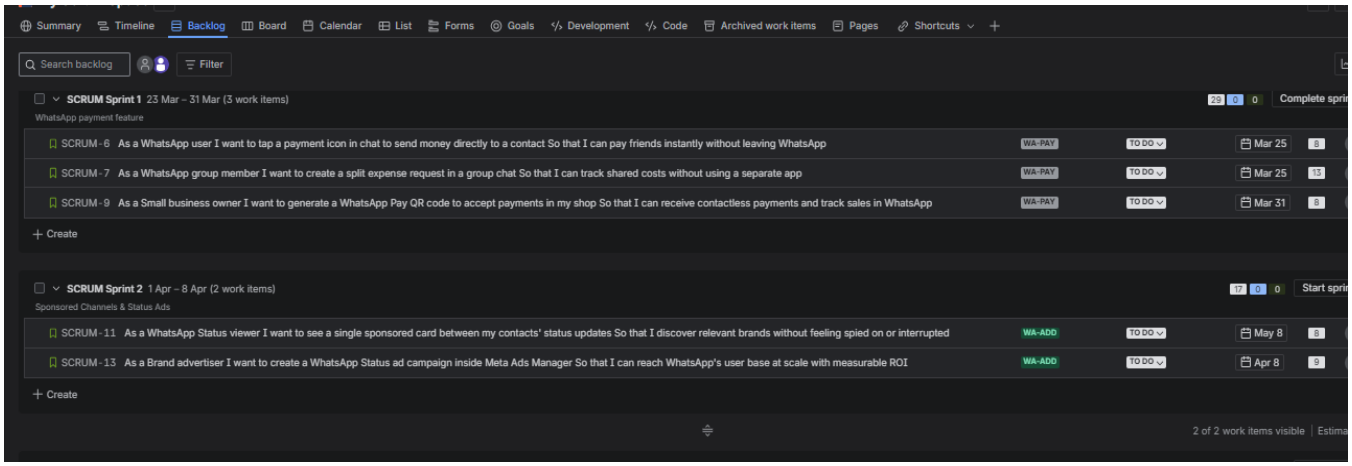
#	Checklist Item	Owner	Status
1	Privacy Impact Assessment completed	Legal / Policy	In Progress
2	On-device ML interest model trained and validated	AI/ML Team	Not Started
3	'Sponsored' disclosure approved by regulators	Legal	Planned
4	Frequency cap system implemented and tested	Engineering	Not Started
5	User preference center (ad frequency control) built	Design	Planned Q2
6	A/B test: 1M user CTR vs satisfaction baseline	Growth	Planned Q3

Jira Epic & User Stories — Status Ads

EPIC WA-ADS-001

Sponsored Channels & Status Ads — Native Ad Platform

Deliver non-intrusive, interest-targeted ads in WhatsApp Status and Channels discovery



F03

FEATURE 03

WhatsApp Premium Subscription

Tiered plans for power users — customisation, storage, and multi-device

Problem Statement

WhatsApp earns zero direct consumer revenue. Telegram Premium launched at $5/month and crossed 4M subscribers within 12 months — proving messaging app users will pay for upgrades. WhatsApp power users are frustrated by file size limits, single-device restrictions, and the lack of any customisation. A tiered subscription unlocks revenue while keeping the core product free for everyone.

Solution

Launch a 3-tier model: Free (current), WhatsApp Plus (₹49/month), and WhatsApp Business Pro (₹199/month). Each tier unlocks progressively more: custom themes, multi-device support, 2GB file transfers, voice message transcription, no ads, and advanced analytics for businesses.

User Flowchart — Subscribe to WhatsApp Plus

1. **Discover Premium**
   User sees 'Upgrade' nudge in Settings or hits a feature limit (e.g. file size)
2. **Open Plan Comparison**
   Settings > WhatsApp Plus — full 3-tier comparison screen loads
3. **Select a Plan**
   User chooses Plus (₹49) or Pro (₹199) — 7-day free trial offered for new subscribers
4. **Payment**
   Payment processed via Google Play / App Store IAP or UPI
5. **Features Unlock**
   All Plus/Pro features activate immediately across all linked devices
6. **Monthly Renewal**
   Auto-renews monthly — user can cancel anytime with no data loss, features freeze gracefully

UI Mockup — WhatsApp Premium Subscription Plans

FREE	PLUS ★ POPULAR	BUSINESS PRO
₹0 / month	₹49 / month	₹199 / month
Messaging & Calls 100MB file sharing 2 linked devices No backup control Ads in Status (future)	✓ Everything in Free ✓ 2GB file transfers ✓ 10 linked devices ✓ Custom themes & fonts ✓ No ads experience ✓ 7-day free trial	✓ Everything in Plus ✓ Advanced analytics ✓ Scheduled messages ✓ CRM integration ✓ Priority support (4h SLA) ✓ Custom business page

Key Success Metrics

Metric	Target	Timeline	Owner
Paid Subscribers	5 Million users	Month 12	Growth PM
Avg Revenue Per Subscriber	₹65 / month	Month 6	Finance
Monthly Churn Rate	< 8%	Month 9	Retention
Feature Adoption (Plus users)	≥ 70% use ≥1 Plus feature	Month 3	Analytics
Subscription ARR	$500 Million	Year 2	Finance

Launch Checklist

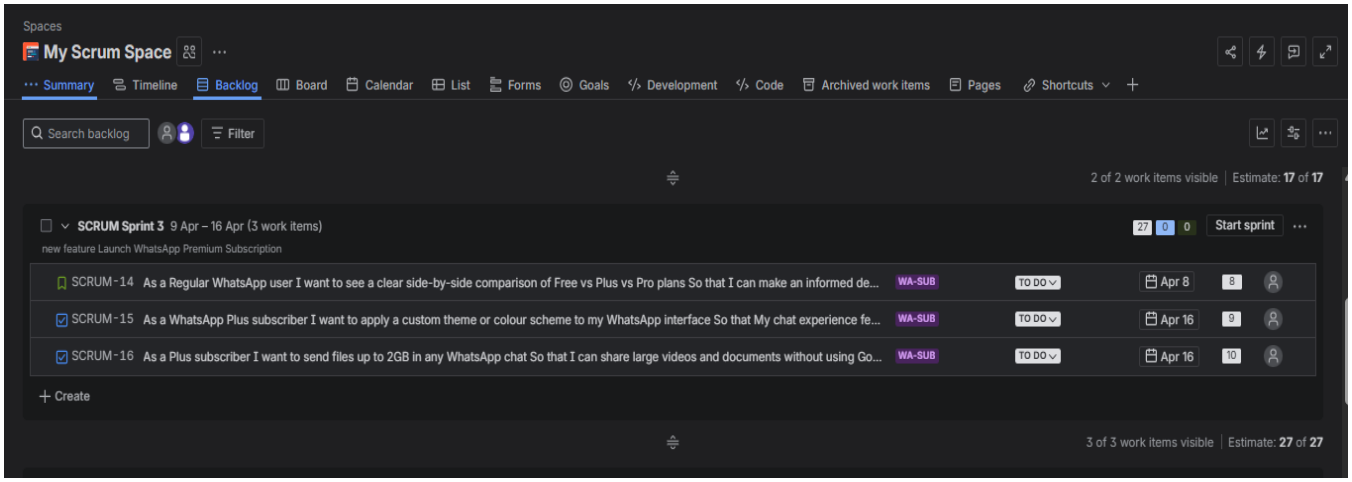
#	Checklist Item	Owner	Status
1	Plan comparison screen UX research completed (3 rounds)	Design	In Progress
2	IAP integration — Google Play Store + Apple App Store	Engineering	Not Started
3	Entitlement management system built and tested	Platform Eng	Planned Q2
4	Multi-device 10x concurrent session load test passed	QA	Not Started
5	Graceful downgrade flow regression tested	QA	Not Started
6	Pricing A/B test: ₹29 vs ₹49 vs ₹99	Growth	Planned Q3

Jira Epic & User Stories — Premium Subscription

EPIC WA-SUB-001

WhatsApp Premium — Tiered Subscription Model

Monetise power users and professionals with a 3-tier subscription offering



F04

FEATURE 04

WhatsApp Business API — Tiered Pricing

Scalable, self-serve B2C messaging platform for SMBs and enterprise

Problem Statement

WhatsApp Business API exists but is opaque, partner-gated, and excludes small businesses. Onboarding takes 7+ days; template approvals take 48 hours; pricing is complex. Twilio, Vonage, and 360dialog capture significant margin as middlemen. Enterprise clients report frustration with poor analytics and rate limits. Meta is leaving billions in API revenue on the table.

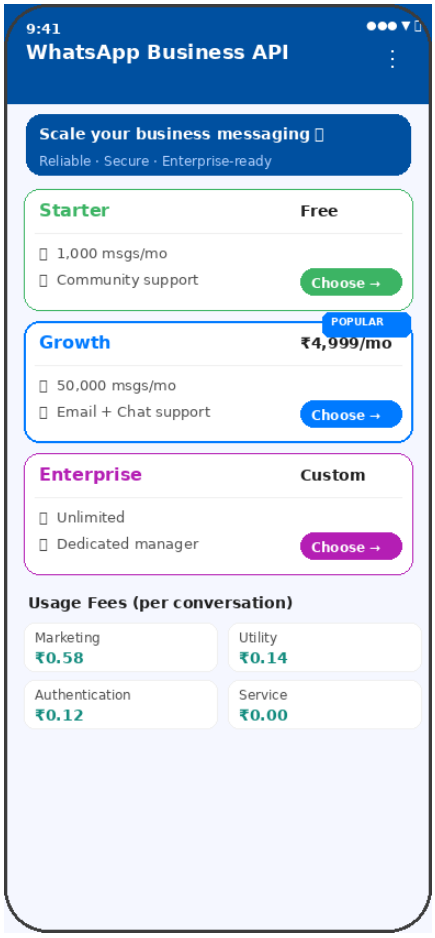
Solution

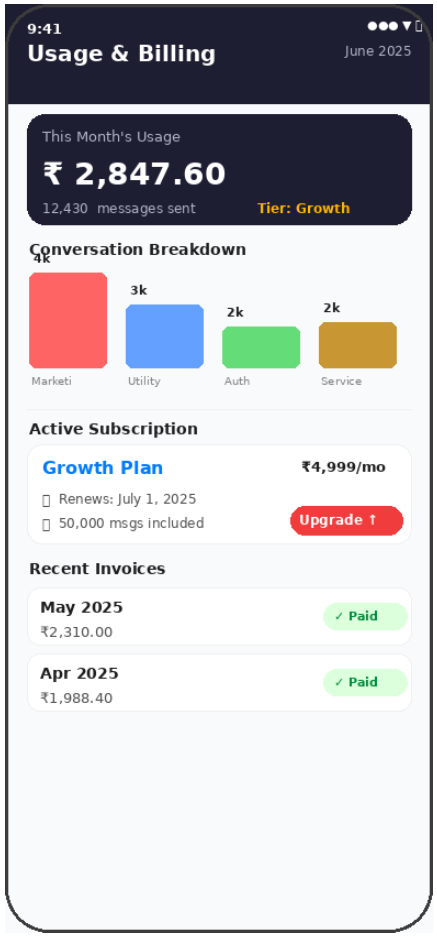
Redesign the Business API as a self-serve product with transparent 3-tier pricing: Starter (free, 1K messages/month), Growth ($99/month, 50K messages), Scale ($499/month, unlimited). Reduce onboarding to under 24 hours. Add AI template creation, real-time analytics, and direct CRM integrations.

User Flowchart — Business API Onboarding

1. **Register at business.whatsapp.com**
   Business enters email, company name, and phone number for verification
2. **Select Tier**
   Choose Starter / Growth / Scale based on monthly message volume needs
3. **Phone Number Verification**
   OTP sent to business number — verified in under 60 seconds, automated for Starter/Growth
4. **Create First Template**
   AI assistant helps draft a compliant template — submitted for approval (target: < 4 hours)
5. **Launch First Campaign**
   Set audience, trigger conditions, and schedule — go live in the dashboard
6. **Monitor & Optimise**
   Real-time analytics: delivered / read / replied / converted — AI suggests best send times

UI Mockup — Business API Dashboard





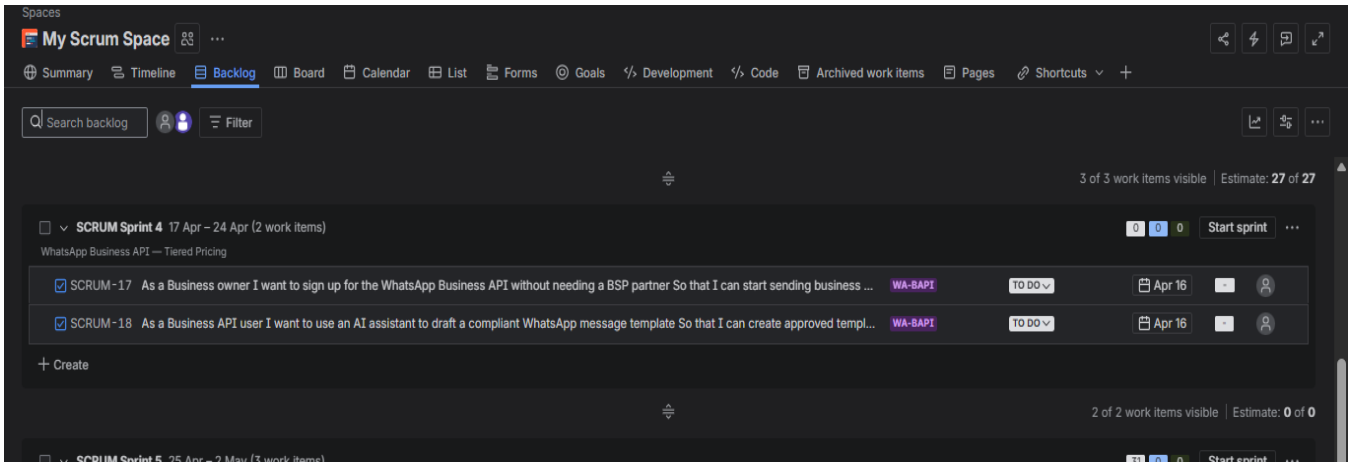
Key Success Metrics

Metric	Target	Timeline	Owner
Active Paying Business Accounts	5M accounts	Year 2	Biz PM
Avg Revenue Per Business Account	$85 / month	Month 12	Finance
Template Approval Time	< 4 hours (p95)	Month 3	Ops
Message Delivery Rate	≥ 99.5%	Month 1	Engineering
Business API ARR	$1.5 Billion	Year 2	Finance

Launch Checklist

#	Checklist Item	Owner	Status
1	Self-serve onboarding flow built and UAT completed	Product / Engineering	In Progress
2	AI template generator v1 trained on approved templates	AI Team	Not Started
3	Template approval pipeline SLA target (4h) agreed with Ops	Operations	In Progress
4	Webhook infra load tested at 100K events per second	SRE	Not Started
5	Stripe + Razorpay billing integration complete	Payments Eng	Planned Q2
6	Salesforce and HubSpot CRM connector v1 shipped	Integrations	Not Started

Jira Epic & User Stories — Business API



F05

FEATURE 05

In-Chat Mini Apps & Commerce

Browse, order, and pay without ever leaving WhatsApp

Problem Statement

E-commerce discovery and purchase still requires users to exit WhatsApp, open a browser or separate app, and re-engage. Cart abandonment in this interrupted flow exceeds 65%. WeChat's Mini Programs process $250B+ in annual commerce. WhatsApp has never built an equivalent, despite having a larger global user base.

Solution

Launch WhatsApp Mini Apps — lightweight web experiences embedded inside WhatsApp (similar to WeChat Mini Programs). Businesses build them using a Mini App SDK (HTML/JS). Users find them via Channel posts, Business chats, or a Mini App store tab. WhatsApp Pay enables 1-tap checkout. Revenue: 2% GMV commission + developer platform fees.

User Flowchart — In-Chat Commerce via Mini App

1. **Discover Mini App**
   User sees a 'Shop Now' card in a Business chat or Channel post
2. **Open Mini App**
   Tapping opens the Mini App as a bottom-sheet overlay inside WhatsApp
3. **Browse & Add to Cart**
   User browses catalogue and adds items — entire experience is within WA
4. **Checkout**
   Name and saved delivery address auto-filled from WhatsApp profile
5. **1-Tap Payment**
   User confirms with biometric auth via WhatsApp Pay
6. **Order Confirmation in Chat**
   Order receipt message sent in the same Business chat — track order in Mini App

UI Mockup — Mini App Commerce Flow

← Zomato Chat •••

Zomato

Hi! Order your favourite

food right here.

[ORDER FOOD]

Open Zomato Mini App

1. Chat Trigger

← Zomato Mini App •••

Zomato — Mini App

Delivering to: Koregaon Park

Margherita Pizza ₹299

[–] 1 [+] Added to cart

Garlic Bread ₹99

[–] 0 [+]

Cart Total: ₹299

Checkout with WA Pay →

2. Mini App Browse + Cart

← Order Confirmed •••

Order #ZMT-29821

Paid: ₹299 via WA Pay ✓

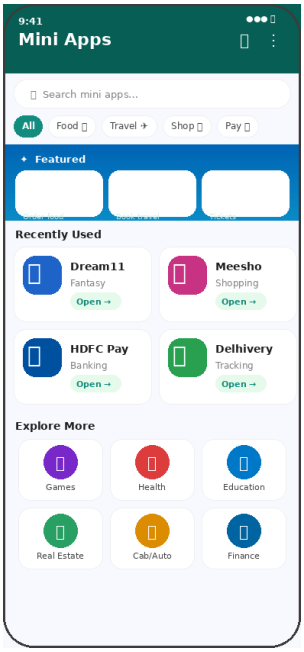
Margherita Pizza x1

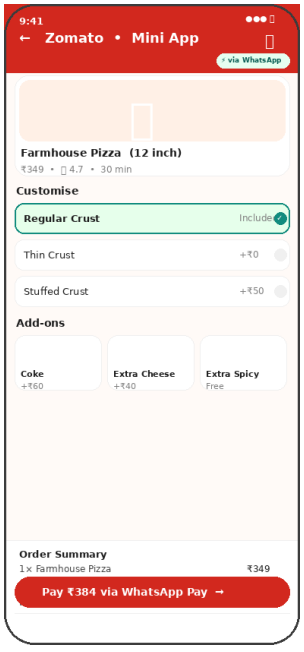
Estimated delivery: 32 min

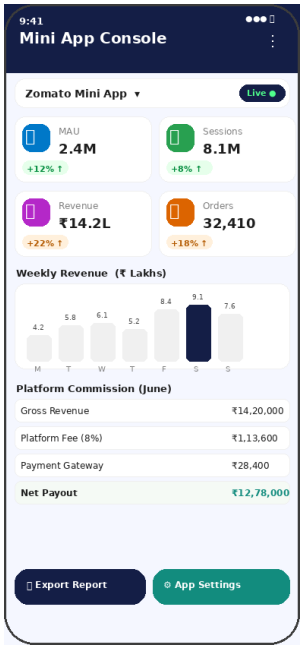
[Track Order in Mini App]

[Rate & Review]

3. Confirmation in Chat







Key Success Metrics

Metric	Target	Timeline	Owner
Mini App Monthly Active Users	100 Million	Year 2	Commerce PM
Annual GMV Processed via WA	$5 Billion	Year 2	Finance
Commission Revenue (2% GMV)	$100M ARR	Year 2	Finance
Mini App Load Time	< 1.5 sec (p95 on 4G)	Month 3	Engineering
Checkout Abandonment Rate	< 30%	Month 6	UX

Launch Checklist

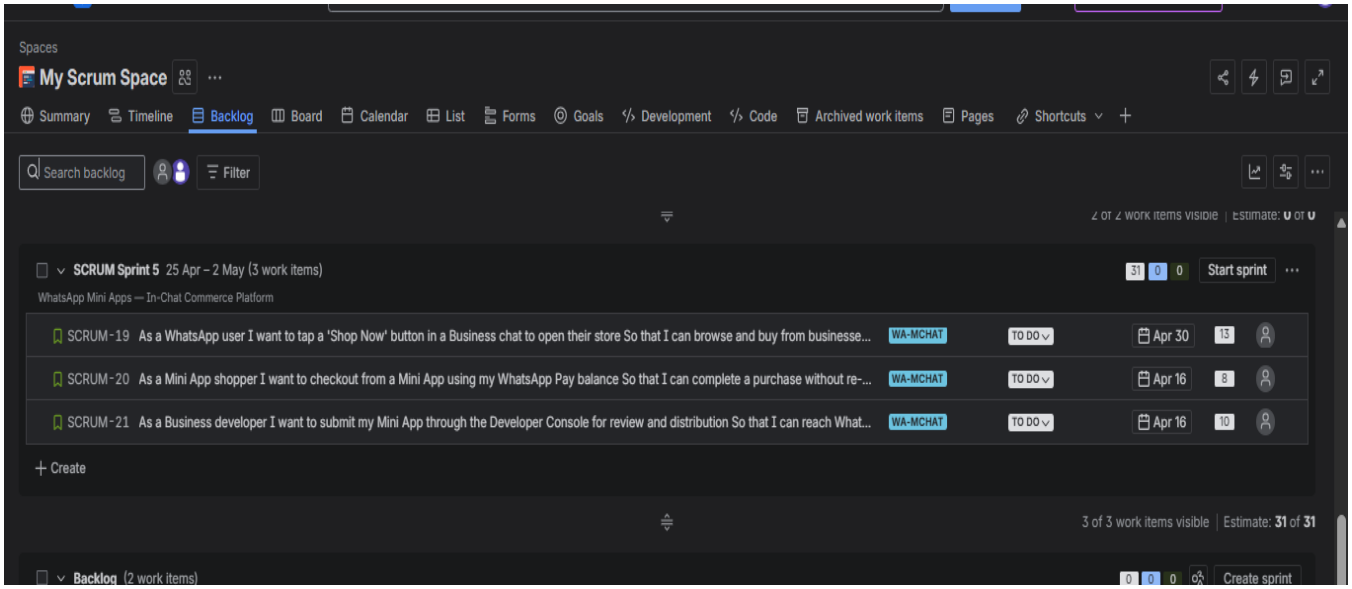
#	Checklist Item	Owner	Status
1	Mini App SDK v1 developer preview released	Platform Engineering	Planned Q2
2	Security sandbox model reviewed by InfoSec	Security	Not Started
3	Mini App store tab added to WhatsApp navigation	Design	Planned Q3
4	WA Pay + Mini App checkout handoff built and tested	Payments Engineering	Not Started
5	Developer Console (deploy / rollback) live	Developer Experience	Planned Q2
6	10 launch-day partner Mini Apps (Zomato, BigBasket, Myntra)	Business Development	In Progress
7	Load test: 50,000 concurrent Mini App sessions passed	SRE	Not Started

Jira Epic & User Stories — Mini Apps

EPIC WA-MINI-001

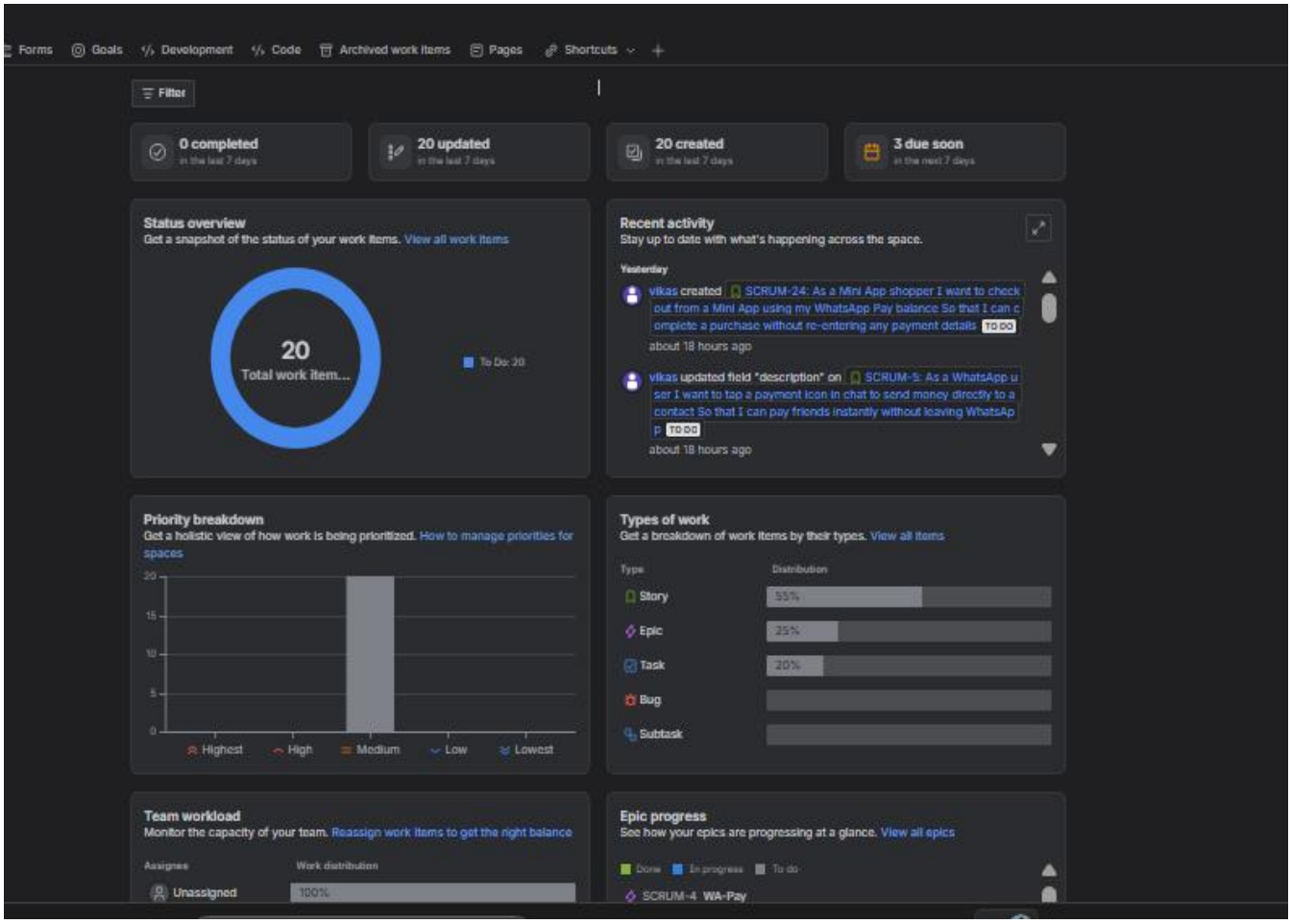
WhatsApp Mini Apps — In-Chat Commerce Platform

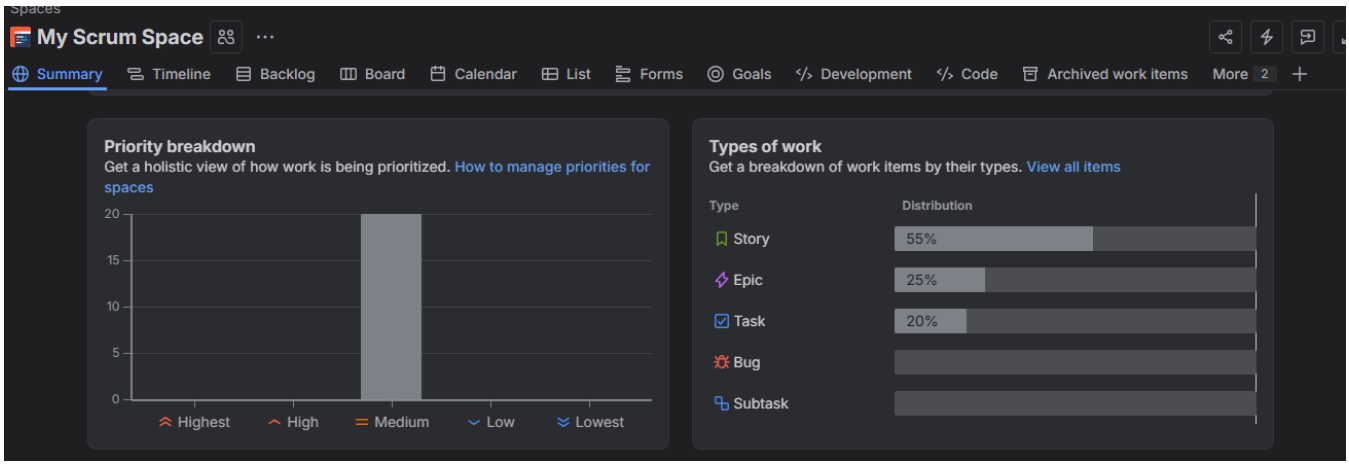
Enable businesses to build lightweight commerce experiences accessible directly from WhatsApp chats

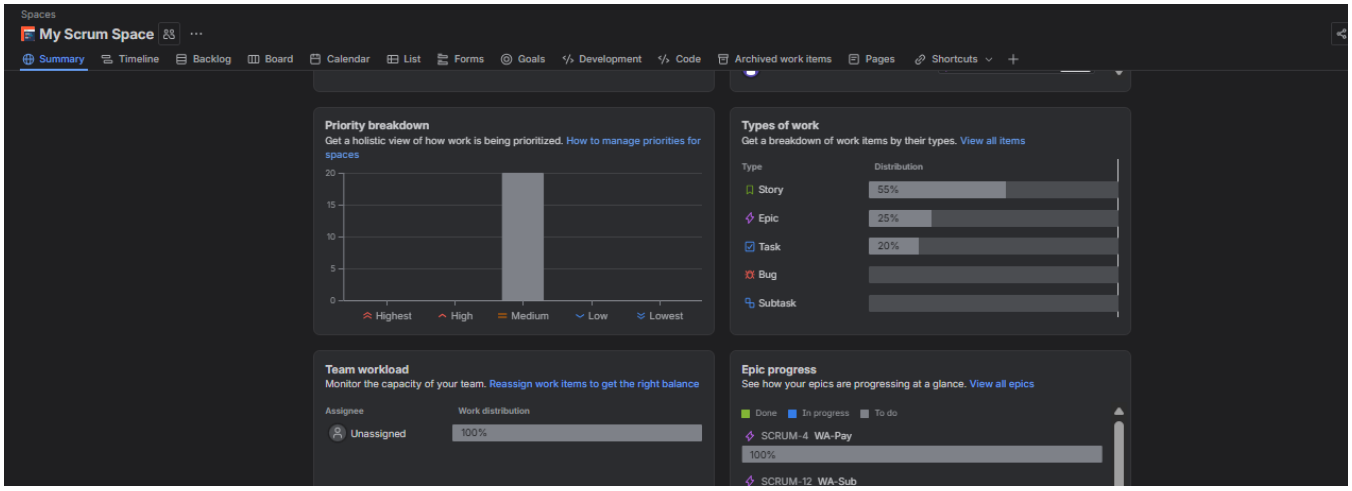


Output Jira Process

Sprint Result time lines and dealines



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Backlog
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Forms
Goals
Development
Code
Archived work items
Pages
Shortcuts
Priority breakdown
Get a holistic view of how work is being prioritized. How to manage priorities for spaces
Highest
High
Medium
Low
Lowest
Types of work
Get a breakdown of work items by their types. View all items
Type
Distribution
Story
55%
Epic
25%
Task
20%
Bug
Subtask
Team workload
Monitor the capacity of your team. Reassign work items to get the right balance
Assignee
Work distribution
Unassigned
100%
Epic progress
See how your epics are progressing at a glance. View all epics
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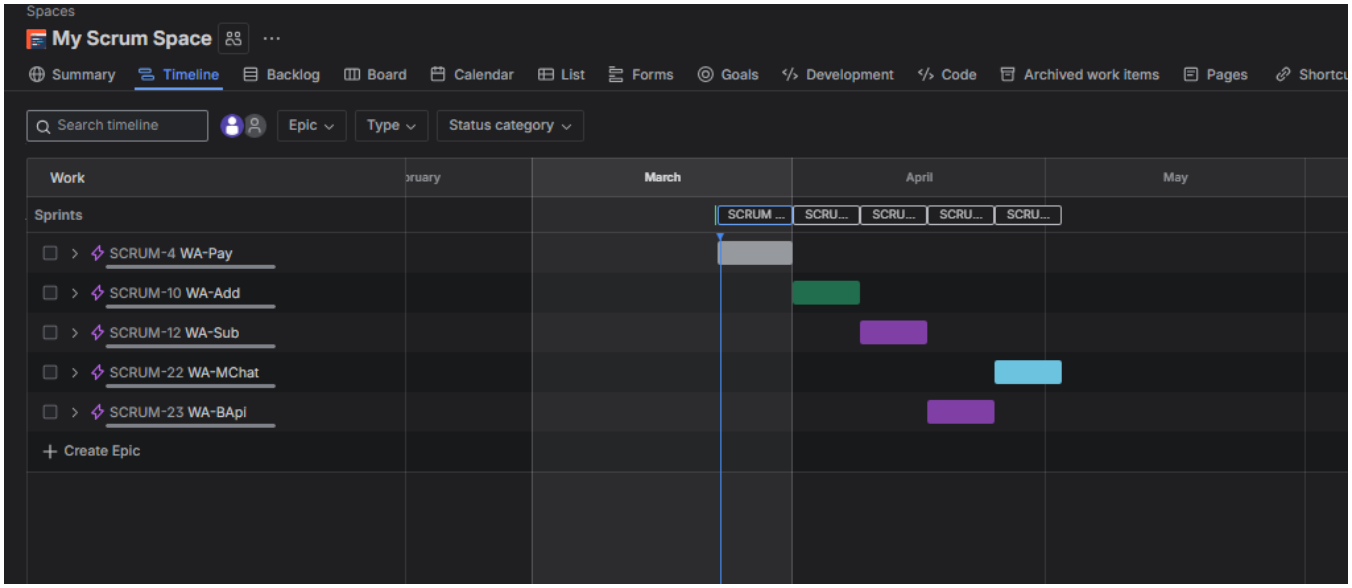
SCRUM-4 WA-Pay
100%
SCRUM-12 WA-Sub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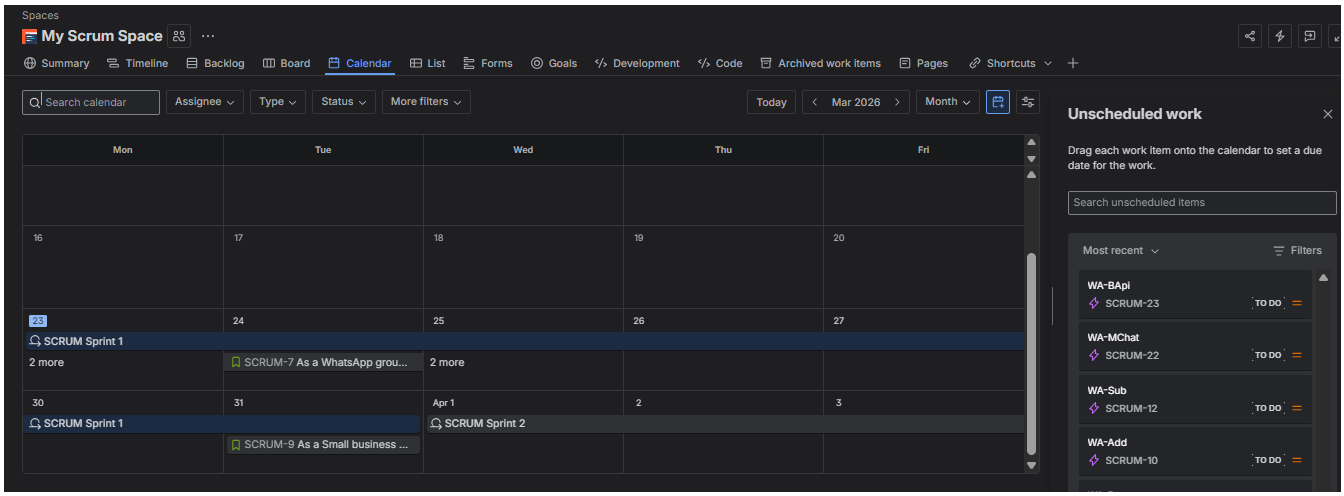
SCRUM-23 WA-BApi
Create Epic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Today
Mar 2026
Month
Mon
Tue
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Thu
Fri
16
17
18
19
20
23
24
25
26
27
SCRUM Sprint 1
2 more
SCRUM-7 As a WhatsApp grou...
2 more
30
31
Apr 1
2
3
SCRUM Sprint 1
SCRUM Sprint 2
SCRUM-9 As a Small business ...
Unscheduled work
Drag each work item onto the calendar to set a due date for the work.
Search unscheduled items
Most recent
Filters
WA-BApi
SCRUM-23
TO DO
WA-MChat
SCRUM-22
TO DO
WA-Sub
SCRUM-12
TO DO
WA-Add
SCRUM-10
TO DO

Cross-Feature Overview

Dependency Map — Feature Phasing

Feature	Depends On	Enables	Launch Phase
F1 — WA Pay	KYC, Banking APIs, Fraud ML	Mini App checkout (F5)	Phase 1 — Q3 2026
F2 — Status Ads	On-device ML, Privacy review	Premium ad-free perk (F3)	Phase 1 — Q3 2026
F3 — Premium	IAP, Entitlement system	Ad-free tier, Plus features	Phase 1 — Q4 2026
F4 — Business API	Self-serve portal, AI templates	Mini App distribution (F5)	Phase 2 — Q1 2027
F5 — Mini Apps	SDK, Pay integration (F1), API (F4)	Full commerce platform	Phase 2 — Q2 2027

Master Revenue & Launch Roadmap

Milestone	Features Involved	Target Date	Status
PRD v1.0 approved by all stakeholders	All	April 2026	In Progress
Legal & compliance review completed	All	May 2026	In Progress
Phase 1 engineering kickoff	F1, F2, F3	June 2026	Planned
WA Pay beta — India 100K users	F1	August 2026	Planned
Status Ads A/B test — 1M users	F2	August 2026	Planned
Premium subscription global launch	F3	October 2026	Planned
Business API self-serve portal live	F4	January 2027	Planned
Mini App SDK developer preview	F5	March 2027	Planned
Full monetization platform GA	All	June 2027	Planned

Total Projected Revenue — Year 2

$4.4 Billion ARR

WA Pay $300M + Status Ads $2B + Premium $500M + Business API $1.5B + Mini Apps $100M

Prepared by Vikas Vishwakarma — WhatsApp Monetization Platform | Version 1.0 | March 2026 | CONFIDENTIAL